PRACTICE 05 · 10-MINUTE

The Uncertainty *Practice*

Uncertainty → **Grounded Presence**

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	*Any time*	*Beginner*	*4*

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Uncertainty feels threatening because the mind is built to anticipate. When it can't find a clear outcome to prepare for, it generates anxiety instead. The scanning doesn't stop. The alertness stays on.

The body tightens. The breath shortens. Decisions become harder. Not because you lack information, but because your nervous system has decided the absence of certainty is itself a threat. This practice is here to remind your body that you are safe in the present, even without knowing what comes next.

> ***"I can meet what comes. I don't need to know it first."***

A note before you begin.

This practiceonly workswhen you actually do it, not when you read about it. The shift happens in your body, not in your head. Trust what you feel during it, even if it surprises you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to track time
- 10 uninterrupted minutes
- Something to write with
- A steady object nearby
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Optional: Frankincense or cedarwood essential oil. Both support grounding when the mind is scanning ahead.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Uncertainty is not a problem to solve. It's a state to move through. This practice uses journalling to name what the mind is doing, then uses the body to interrupt the scanning and return you to the present moment.

1	Journalling	*3 min*
2	Body Grounding	*4 min*
3	Presence Breath	*2 min*
4	Close	*1 min*

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

7 MINUTES

With uncertainty, the automatic chain looks like this: something unknown arises, your brain predicts danger, anxiety spikes, and you spend the day spinning through what-ifs trying to get control. Each loop makes the habit stronger.

The practice creates a pause in that chain. Between the 'I don't know' and the anxiety spiral, there is a gap. In that gap, you can see the thoughts your brain is generating, question whether they're facts or predictions, and find something more grounded to stand on.

1. BREATHE IN

Take three slow breaths. Inhale for 4 counts, exhale for 6. With each exhale, say quietly: 'Right now, I am okay.'

Say it because it's true — not because everything is figured out. This is the shift from scanning for what might happen to simply being here.

2. FIND IT IN YOUR BODY

Without trying to fix anything, notice: Where am I feeling uncertainty or anxiety right now?

Maybe it's a low hum of unease in your gut. A restlessness that makes it hard to sit still. A jumping mind, eyes that keep scanning. Approach it with a beginner's mind — curiosity rather than dread.

3. WRITE YOUR THOUGHTS

Set a timer for 60-90 seconds. Let your brain say everything it's been generating — the predictions, the fears, the what-ifs.

Read them back. These are automatic thoughts your brain produced to try to protect you. Not facts about the future. Not one of them is certain, including the worst ones.

4. FIND A THOUGHT YOU CAN BELIEVE

Find the thought carrying the most anxiety. Now look for a thought that anchors you in yourself and in what's actually true right now.

Some options to try:

"I don't know how this will turn out, and I can handle it either way."

"I've navigated uncertainty before. I'm still here."

"I don't need to know the outcome to take the next step."

"I trust myself more than I trust the fear."

02 Body Grounding

4 MINUTES

When the mind is scanning ahead, the body loses its sense of where it is right now. Proprioceptive grounding — pressing into the floor and noticing physical sensation — pulls attention back into the present. It interrupts the scanning at the physiological level, not just the cognitive one.

1. THE PRACTICE

Sit or stand with both feet flat on the floor. Press them gently but firmly downward.

Notice the weight of your body. Notice the surface beneath you. Notice the temperature of your hands. Hold the steady object. Feel its weight and texture.

Let your attention rest on what is physically here, right now. If the mind pulls forward, gently return to sensation. There is nothing to figure out in this moment.

03 Presence Breath

2 MINUTES

A slow, extended exhale activates the parasympathetic nervous system and signals safety to the body. It's one of the fastest ways to shift from threat state to present state.

1. THE BREATH

Inhale slowly through the nose for 4 counts. Hold for 4. Exhale through the mouth for 6 to 8 counts.

Repeat for several rounds. Let the exhale be longer than the inhale each time. Notice what is present. Notice what is stable. Notice that you are here.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Place one hand on your heart. Choose one statement that feels grounded and true right now.

"I don't need to know what comes next to be okay right now."

"I can respond when something actually happens."

"This moment doesn't need my vigilance."

PRACTICE COMPLETE

You don't need to predict what's coming next to be okay right now.

Today, youlet yoursystemstop scanningfor amoment. That matters.Youcanmeetthingsastheyarrive.

Return to this practice whenever uncertainty starts pulling you out of the present.

Creating inner balance, one grounded pause at a time.

CONTINUE THE WORK

The Full Library. All five Practices for $57.

Overwhelm isone layer.Pressure,self-doubt,uncertainty,andguilt are the others. The Full Library gives you a structured practice for each one.

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